

Codebook and Spreadsheet Guide

PST 315: Methods of Policy Analysis and Presentation

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About these examples

The examples below use **sample data**. Skills Win Coaching Organization is a real Syracuse University program, but the survey, variables, and responses shown here are invented for teaching purposes and are not actual SWCO results.

Creating your codebook

Step 1: In Word, create a table with four columns: **Column**, **Field Name**, **Definition**, and **Code**.

Column	Field Name	Definition	Code
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The number of rows depends on the number of questions you have on your survey or how many research questions you have. As a general rule:

$$\text{Number of questions} + 2 = \text{Number of rows in your codebook table}$$

The +2 rows account for the header row and the respondent ID row.

Step 2: Create a list of variables from your questions. These will be your Field Name and Definition columns.

- Your **field name** should be a short word or a few letters describing the variable. (*Example: grade level = GRADE, or engagement = ENGAGE.*)
- Your **definition** should be the original question or a description of the variable. (*Example: “What grade are you in?” or “Code is identical to the respondent’s ID number.”*)

Column	Field Name	Definition	Code
A	ID	Respondent's unique identification number	Code is identical to identification number
B	SITE	Which site session did you attend?	
C	GRADE	What grade are you in?	

Note: each field name (variable) aligns with a column of your spreadsheet according to your codebook.

Step 3: Repeat step 2 for all of your questions.

Column	Field Name	Definition	Code
A	ID	Respondent's unique identification number	Code is identical to identification number
B	SITE	Which site session did you attend?	
C	GRADE	What grade are you in?	
D	COACH	The coaches were helpful.	
E	ENGAGE	The exercises were engaging.	
F	IMPROVE	What could be improved at your site sessions?	

Step 4: Assign a code to each possible answer for each question. Your variable type will make a difference here.

Note: for open-ended responses, you should create up to 5 or 6 categories to place the open-ended responses into. See the [Qualitative Coding Guide](#).

Step 5: In your spreadsheet, you will use your codebook to code your raw data.

Codebook example

Column	Field Name	Definition	Code
A	ID	Respondent's unique identification number	Code is identical to identification number
B	SITE	Which site session did you attend?	1 = Site A2 = Site B3 = Site C99 = No response
C	GRADE	What grade are you in?	1 = 9th2 = 10th3 = 11th4 = 12th99 = No response
D	COACH	The coaches were helpful.	1 = Strongly disagree2 = Disagree3 = Neutral4 = Agree5 = Strongly agree99 = No response
E	ENGAGE	The exercises were engaging.	1 = Strongly disagree2 = Disagree3 = Neutral4 = Agree5 = Strongly agree99 = No response
F	IMPROVE	What could be improved at your site sessions?	Open ended response:1 = More activities2 = More time3 = Smaller groups4 = Better materials5 = Nothing99 = No response

Creating your spreadsheet

Step 6: Once you have created your codebook, it is time to code your data in Excel using the codes you just created above.

Why do we do this? By coding your data, it will make your data far easier to comprehend and to analyze.

Step 7: Open a new Excel spreadsheet. Begin by typing the field names for each of your variables from your codebook into the first row of the sheet.

ID	SITE	GRADE	COACH	ENGAGE	IMPROVE
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Step 8: Save this Excel spreadsheet and turn it in along with your Codebook document and Revised Executive Summary for your assignment.

Once you have your data

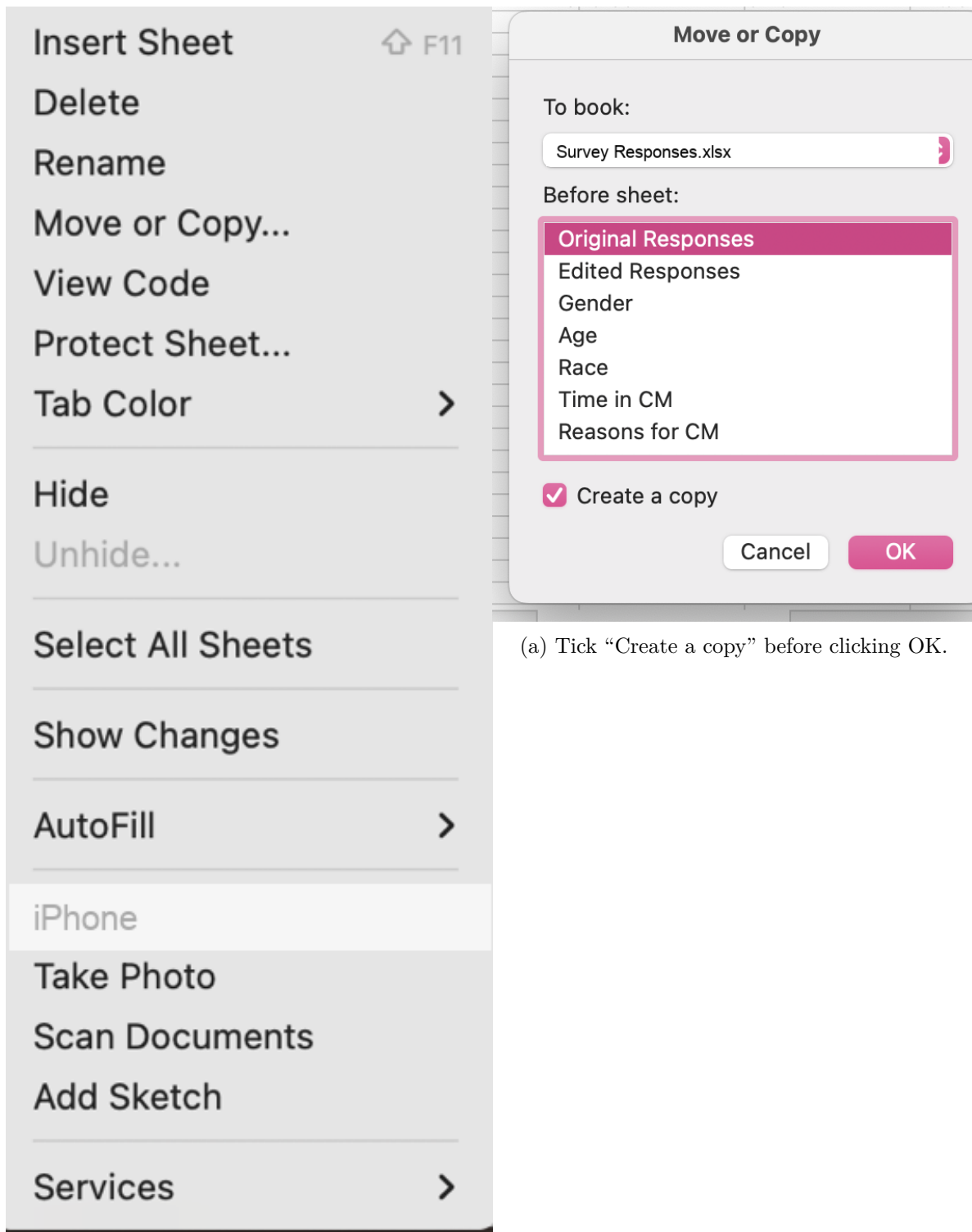
Step 9: Copy your data into your spreadsheet and create a copy of your responses. You want to save an original version of your data along with the coded data. You can create a copy by right-clicking on the spreadsheet tab, selecting “Move or Copy,” and selecting to copy. This will create a new tab with the same data – name these tabs “Original Responses” and “Coded Responses” to ensure these don’t get mixed up.

Step 10: Once you have a copy of your responses to edit, you should start coding all of the responses based on your codebook. Coding will look different depending on your types of variables. Ask your UCA any questions about specific variables.

Coded data looks like this – every answer replaced by its code from the codebook:

ID	SITE	GRADE	COACH	ENGAGE	IMPROVE
1	1	3	5	4	1
2	2	4	4	5	2
3	1	2	3	3	1
4	3	4	5	2	3
5	2	3	4	5	5
6	1	1	2	3	2
7	3	2	5	4	99

Hint: use the Find and Replace feature in Excel to quickly code multiple-choice variables.



(a) Tick “Create a copy” before clicking OK.

(a) Right-click the sheet tab and choose Move or Copy.